



RAYS OF GRACE ACADEMY

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PROPOSAL FOR STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP AND YOUTH FOOTBALL DEVELOPMENT SUPPORT BETWEEN RAYS OF GRACE ACADEMY & MODERN GROUP COMPANY

1. Introduction

Rays of Grace Academy is a youth football development academy based in Njeru Municipality, Buikwe District, Uganda, committed to identifying and nurturing talented young players into disciplined athletes and responsible future leaders, **with a dream of creating a pathway to greatness**. The academy uses football as a tool for social transformation by providing professional training, education support, mentorship, and life-skills development.



The Academy's leadership is strengthened by the fact that its Director also serves as the Chairman of the **Uganda Youth Football Association (UYFA)**, ensuring strong alignment with national youth football development pathways.

To achieve Regional, National and International impact, Rays of Grace Academy seeks strategic partnerships and invites **Modern Group Company** to join us in building champions and empowering communities through football.



Rays of Grace Academy Uganda



@Rays Uganda



Rays of Grace Academy

2. Background of the Academy

Rays of Grace Academy was founded in 2016 by Mr. Roberts Kiwanuka with the mission to educate and prepare players for excellence in football through a well-structured coaching and education program that develops their skills, discipline, and overall performance both on and off the pitch. The academy was established after recognizing the lack of structured opportunities available to many talented young footballers in Uganda who had the potential to succeed but lacked access to proper training facilities, mentorship, education, and exposure.

Starting as a small initiative aimed at nurturing football talent in the community, the academy has grown into a respected youth sports institution serving hundreds of young players aged between 6 and 18 years. The academy operates throughout the year and offers professional coaching programs designed to develop players technically, physically, mentally, and socially.



The academy has steadily grown into one of Uganda's recognized youth football institutions, offering structured sports programs that emphasize honesty, discipline, teamwork, integrity, and holistic child development. Rays of Grace Academy is officially registered with the **Uganda Youth Football Association (UYFA)** and has participated in several national and

regional competitions, producing young players who continue to excel at different levels of football.

Rays of Grace Academy has achieved significant success in youth football competitions both nationally and regionally. Has gained national recognition after winning the inaugural FUFA Primary Schools Championship (Odilo) in 2019 and successfully defending the title in 2022. The academy has also competed in tournaments such as the Airtel Rising Stars Championship, Kabaka Cup, UYFA competitions, FEASSA Games, FUFA Academies League, and several other youth football tournaments across East Africa.

The academy's development approach goes beyond football by focusing on holistic child development through education, discipline, leadership, moral values, and mentorship. Rays of Grace Academy works closely with guardians, coaches, and development partners to ensure that children receive support both academically and socially while pursuing their sporting careers.



Despite its achievements, the academy continues to face challenges including limited financial resources, inadequate training equipment, transportation difficulties, and the need for improved sports facilities and player welfare support. To continue transforming the lives of young athletes and expanding opportunities for youth development, Rays of Grace Academy seeks sponsorship and strategic partnership with **Modern Group Company** to empower communities and support the future of Ugandan youth through sports.

Mission

To nurture young talent holistically by integrating elite football training with academic support, character development, and life-skills education.

Vision

To become the most prolific producer of football talent in East Africa while transforming communities through sports, education, and leadership development.

Main Objective

To provide young people within the community with opportunities for professional football development and personal growth.

Other Objectives

- ❖ To transform Rays of Grace Academy into a nationally recognized hub for football talent development
- ❖ To identify, nurture, and support talented children from Njeru and surrounding communities into national and international football stars.
- ❖ To contribute players to Uganda's national teams across various age categories.

Core Values

- ❖ Honesty
- ❖ Fairness
- ❖ Friendliness
- ❖ Discipline
- ❖ Integrity

At Rays of Grace Academy, every child is seen, valued, and guided not only to succeed in football, but also to succeed in life.

2. Achievements of the Academy

Over the years, Rays of Grace Academy has recorded significant milestones that speak to our credibility, visibility, and measurable impact within the community and beyond. We have now grown into a recognized incredible football academy, one that has become a genuine source of national team talent.

Journey of a few Developed players to the National Level

“From Community Roots to Global Greatness”

Arafat Nkoola who is known as Uganda U17 World Cup Hero, Arafat Nkoola arrived at Rays of Grace Academy in 2017 as a quiet boy from a humble background. Today, he stands as one of Uganda's most promising young footballers as he showcased in the U17 World Cup in 2025 where his goal gave cranes a lead against Burkina Faso in the round of 16 though it was equalised later and ended in 5-3 loss in penalty shoot out against Burkina Faso that ended Uganda's campaign.



Simon Wanyama is also another key player who has been raised here, Simon is a consistent performer for both academy and country, developing alongside Nkoola through the Rays of Grace system. He was part of the Uganda Cubs squad that made history by qualifying for the U17 World Cup, the first Uganda football team ever to reach a global World Cup stage. Selected for the **U15 National Team** squad for the CECAFA U15 tournament in 2023, to mention but a few.



Community Engagements & Social Transformation

At Rays of Grace Academy, we believe that football is more than a game because it drives social change, community unity, and lasting transformation. Our work extends far beyond the pitch and into the hearts and homes of the families we serve.



Through HFF initiatives and dedicated community outreach programs, Rays of Grace actively engages with women and families, the true backbone of any community. Our community engagements include;

Programs	Impact
Women's Empowerment	Supporting women and their families through their own businesses through creating women groups
Children Empowerment	Providing education and family support through sponsorship programs
Sanitation and Health Care	Bringing to you happy and healthy solutions through preventing diseases and illness
Community Outreach	Loving through action to better lives of families and communities

Some of the recent key Honors of the Academy

A goal from Hamis Nalapa secured a 1–0 victory for Rays of Grace Academy against Namagabi UMEA in the UPSSA 2025 competition. The match was played at Ndeba C/U Playground, with both teams displaying determination and impressive football talent

The Academy retained their Buganda region FUFA Odilo championship title after a sound 4-0 win over Masaka-based Becker Infant School in the final played at Latifah Mixed secondary school playgrounds in Kabimbiri-Mukono.



Amos Molu had a brace while Nicholas Kawooya and Steven Sseruwagi scored one each as Rays of Grace won the title for the third straight time.



On a busy Saturday morning at the Panamera sports grounds in December 2022. Hundreds of kids aged under 10, 12 and 14 from seven academies including hosts Joe Kigozi academy, Rays of Grace, Excel academy, Proline, Aliguma, Teletubies and Discovery exhibited their skills in the inaugural JKA Juniors tournament where Rays of Grace Academy Emerged as Champions.



Rays of Grace Academy won the Sports for Climate Change Mitigation Tournament after a hard-fought 1–0 victory over Brentford Soccer Academy. The winning goal was scored by Musika Sowed during the match played at Twin Brook Soccer Ground. The tournament brought together young players to promote environmental awareness through sports while showcasing their football talents.



In 2019, Rays of Grace Academy emerged victorious in the FUFA Primary Schools Champions competition after securing a 1–0 win over Oasis Primary School. The match was played at Njeru Technical Center, with Leonard scoring the decisive goal to seal the victory for Rays of Grace Academy. The game showcased determination, teamwork, and outstanding young football talent.



3. National Engagement and Impact

Today, many of our graduates have proudly worn the Uganda national jersey across different age categories from the U15 national team to the U17 World Cup stage and beyond. This is not an accident. It is the result of a deliberate, disciplined, and holistic development system led by our Academy Director who also serves as the Chairman of the Uganda Youth Football Association (UYFA), a position that connects our work directly to national football structures, FUFA, and youth development pathways as sampled in the table below.

Player	National Team Representation	Current Status
Arafat Nkoola	Uganda U17 – Scored at FIFA U17 World Cup (Qatar 2025)	Professional footballer at Hammarby FC in Sweden
Simon Wanyama	Uganda U17 – Scored at AFCON U17 in Morocco (2025)	Active National team prospect
Denis Walisimbi	Uganda youth international	Professional footballer at FC Copenhagen in Denmark
Vicent Mulema	Uganda U15 & U20 National Teams	Active
Enock Luyima	Uganda U20 National Team	Active
Elisa Talemwa	Uganda U17 – CECAFA U17 winning squad	Active
Frank Ssekanjako	Uganda U15 & U17 – CECAFA U17 winner	Vipers SC JT
Disan Mwebe	Uganda U15 National Team	Active
Samuel Mubiru	Uganda U15 National Team	Active

*Note that; in 2023 alone, **twelve Rays of Grace players** were summoned to the U15 National Team for the CECAFA tournament in Uganda, of which **eight of them started on the pitch**, a testament to the academy's unmatched talent identification and development system.*

Some of the key moments during National Engagements





4. Why Rays of Grace Academy Should Partner with Modern Group

We believe Modern Group is more than a manufacturing company; it is a trusted partner in Ugandan homes for community progress. A partnership with Rays of Grace Academy offers not just visibility, but a powerful opportunity to deepen that legacy by directly investing in the champions which will in turn transform the Kirugu community and inspire our nations.

- **CSR Alignment with Proven Community Impact:** Modern Group has already demonstrated commitment to community welfare through health, hygiene, and disease prevention initiatives.
- **Infrastructure & Legacy Opportunities:** We will attach the Modern Group name to some physical assets, a branded community football field, changing rooms and facilities, named trophies, branded fan zones, and community gathering spaces where families watch and celebrate together.
- **Access to Uganda's Football Ecosystem (UYFA & FUFA Networks):** Through our Academy Director, who serves as the Chairman of the Uganda Youth Football Association (UYFA), Rays of Grace offers partners a direct pipeline into FUFA structures, youth leagues, national tournaments, and talent identification programs.
- **Positive Public Image & Community Enabler Status:** Sponsoring a talent academy that produces national team players and international professionals transforms Modern Group from a corporate entity into a community enabler. Your brand will be celebrated by parents who see you investing in their children's futures, educators who value our scholarship programs placing kids in schools like St. Mary's Kitende SSS, Amus College, Bukedea Comprehensive among others, local governments who recognize your role in youth development and crime reduction, and football fans who connect your brand to winning and national pride.
- **Employee Welfare & Health Initiatives:** Partners can support employee welfare initiatives such as health and ambulance programs. Rays of Grace can serve as a community distribution point for health awareness materials, ambulance or medical support programs, employee volunteer opportunities like coaching clinics and mentorship days, and welfare outreach to player families.



- **Grassroots Legacy That Builds Future Consumers:** While many sponsors chase elite leagues and television audiences, football builds authentic, lasting emotional connection with future consumers. Every child who wears a Modern Group-branded kit becomes a brand ambassador for life. Every parent who watches their child play on a Modern Group-supported pitch becomes a loyal customer. Every community that benefits from your support becomes a testimonial for your brand.

“Rays of Grace is where future stars are shaped and we invite Modern Group to write that story with us.”

5. Benefits the Academy Seeks from the Partnership

To scale our impact, we respectfully seek the following support from Modern Group:

- **Sponsorship Funding:** This will cover registration fees, coach stipends, and medical insurance.
- **Training Equipment:** Footballs, cones, bibs, goalkeeper gloves, and first-aid kits.
- **Playing & Training Kits:** 3 full sets (home, away and training) with Modern Group branding.
- **Transport Support:** Bus/taxi hire or even fuel for away matches and national tournaments.
- **Tournament Sponsorship:** Title sponsorship for our annual “Rays of Grace Community Cup” we think of it to have over 20 teams.
- **Infrastructure:** Pitch maintenance, changing rooms, and simple floodlights for evening training.
- **Scholarships for Top Talent:** Support for outstanding players to attend football & academics.
- **Media Exposure:** Feature academy progress on Modern Group digital platforms.

- Mentorship: Staff engagement sessions on leadership, career guidance, and responsible life choices.

6. Mutual Benefits of the Partnership

For Rays of Grace Academy	For Modern Group Limited
Sustained football operations	High impact visibility
Better equipment and safety	Positive brand association with youth & sports
Access to national tournaments	Grassroots marketing reach which will reach parents, schools, and local leaders
Talent exposure & player development	Opportunity for employee volunteering & teambuilding
Long-term planning ability	Media coverage on our platforms & partner networks

This is not a donation, it is a strategic alliance that builds community goodwill while elevating Modern Group' brand among Uganda's next generation.

7. Conclusion and Call to Action

Rays of Grace Academy is not waiting for permission to change lives; we are doing it every day with the resources that we currently have. But with Modern Group by our side, we could reach ten times more young people, produce national-level players, and set a new standard for grassroots sports in Uganda.

We respectfully request a meeting with your Sponsorship Committee to present our vision in person, share testimonials and photos then discuss a tailored sponsorship package.

Draft Sponsorship Package for Discussion:

Final budget will be shared upon acceptance of partnership discussions.

Together, we can turn raw talent into national pride. Together, we can keep youth focused, fit, and hopeful one match at a time.

We eagerly await your positive response and the opportunity to discuss how Rays of Grace Academy and Modern Group can score a goal for Uganda's future.